



Reader Tip

Cutting a portion of Video file using VirtualDub

This is a very useful feature of VirtualDub. With it you can extract a portion of a movie and save it. To extract a portion of video from a movie file, just put the movie CD in your CD drive and Open VirtualDub. Here, we are going to just extract the movie file and are not applying any compression to it. To enable compression, you will need Video Codecs such as Xvid or Indeo. Now make sure the following settings are applied in VirtualDub:

VirtualDub > Options > Preferences:
 "OutPut Color Depth" should be "Match Display Depth"
 "Display" should be set to "Use DirectX for displaying panes"

VirtualDub > Video > Compression should be set to 'Uncompressed RGB / YCbCr'

VirtualDub > Audio > Directstream Copy
 After the options are saved, select the portion that you want to extract. Just move the Timeline slider until you reach the starting point of the scene you want to extract. Press [Home] to mark the start position of the selection. Now move the slider until you reach the end position of the scene you want to extract. Press [End] to mark the end position of the selection. Now, go to File > Save as AVI or Press [F7]. In the Save As dialog box, specify where you want this file to be saved, hit [Enter], and you are done.
Contributed by Shahab Jafri (it_waaznt_me on the ThinkDigit Forum)

the slider to select a frame that will let you easily identify which clip this is.

Now, click on the little camera icon (the Poster Frame button), which is located on the left of the project pane. This will set the current frame as a poster or thumbnail for the selected clip. Repeat this for all the clips that you want to set a poster for.

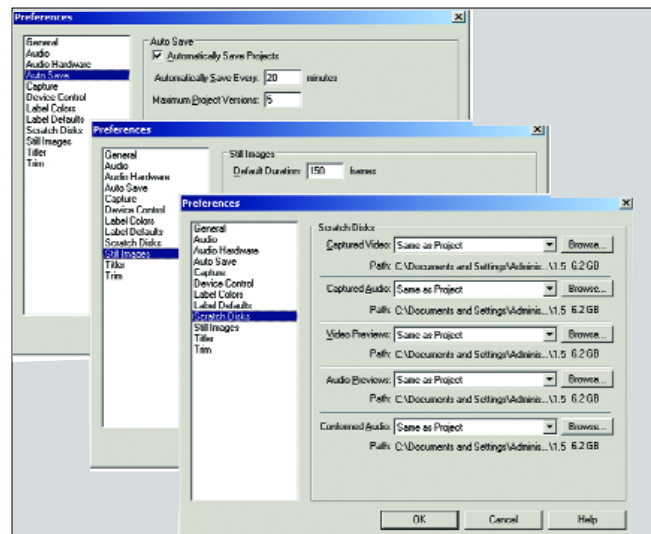


Preferences

As with any software, you need to set preferences and default values for a lot of tasks. Thankfully, this is easily achieved in Premiere Pro by going to Edit > Preferences, and then clicking on an option. The available options are: General, Audio, Audio Hardware, Auto Save, Capture, Device Control, Label Colors, Label Defaults, Scratch Disks, Still Images, Titler and Trim.

The three most important settings that you need to modify according to your choice and computer hardware are:

Auto Save: Depending on available disk space, amount of editing and your paranoia, set the 'Auto Save

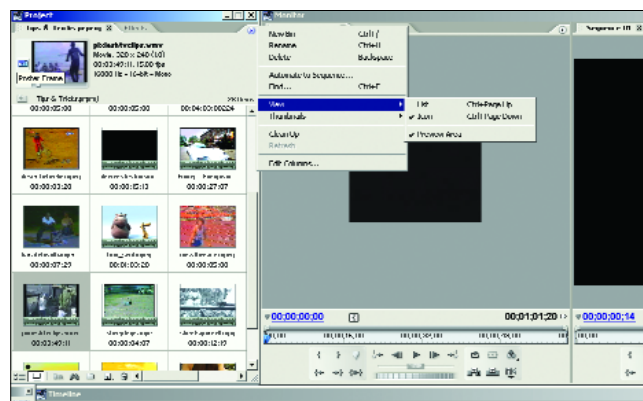


Set your project preferences; the three most important settings are 'Auto Save', 'Still Images' and 'Scratch Disks'

Every...' value. Twenty minutes is fine, unless you

are doing heavy editing, in which case you should reduce this. You can also change the 'Maximum Project Versions' value to a higher number. There is no need to reduce this, as it is vital to have at least five file versions when editing video.

Scratch Disks: Depending on your computer configuration, and free space, you should modify these values. For example, if your computer has more than one hard disk, you can set the captured audio and video and the preview files to the secondary hard disk. This is also helpful to those



Set the clip view in the Project pane to Icon and use the 'Poster' button to set a recognisable frame as the clip icon

Keyboard Shortcuts

Here are some keyboard shortcuts you will need to know when using Adobe Premiere Pro. These will help you work faster

Selection tool	V
Track select tool	M
Ripple edit tool	B
Rolling edit tool	N
Rate stretch tool	X
Razor tool	C
Slide tool	U
Slip tool	Y
Pen tool	P
Hand tool	H
Zoom tool	Z
Navigate through editable fields	Tab
Cancel capture	Esc
Eject	E